Ecologists also studied the diversity of beetles and flies in nine parks of different sizes in Cincinnati, Ohio. Area was the best predictor of species richness, but when the ecologists coupled their findings with data on population sizes, they calculated that an increased size of parkland acts primarily to reduce extinction rates rather than to provide habitats for new species.



Central Park in Manhattan, New York City, is an "island" in an urban setting. Its checklist includes 134 bird species, 197 insect, 9 mammal, 5 reptile, 59 fungi, and 441 plant species.

"Destroying rainforest for economic gain is like burning a Renaissance painting to cook a meal."

Edward O. Wilson